

MEET THE DOERS

THE INDIA TODAY GROUP'S 'DRIVERS OF CHANGE' AWARDS RECOGNISED THOSE WHO HAVE MADE LANDMARK CONTRIBUTIONS TO FIELDS AS VARIED AS INTERIOR DESIGN, HEALTHCARE, MILITARY TECHNOLOGY AND MORE, THROUGH HOMEGROWN INGENUITY AND SKILL

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Photographs by
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Individuals across India, who have quietly been reshaping their milieus by creating new employment opportunities, advancing healthcare and preparing the military for next-level conflicts, were felicitated at the 'Drivers of Change' awards, held on March 24 in Mumbai. Organised by the India Today Group (ITG) and Mahindra & Mahindra Ltd, India's leading SUV manufacturer, the third season was about achievements in corporate India after previous editions focused on women leaders and heritage development. ITG's Auto Today team travelled 10,000 km across the country to find this year's winners on home turf, driving the XUV 7XO.

"We are honouring 17 remarkable young founders who have transformed their ideas into extraordinary enterprises," said Jishnu Dev Varma, governor of Maharashtra, at the keynote address. "History reminds us that extraordinary achievements are often born in youth." The award show highlighted a staggering statistic. More than 100 Indian companies have achieved unicorn status, that is, they have been valued at more than $1 billion (Rs 9,354 crore). Last year clocked the registration of 44,000 startups, which is the highest single-year addition since the Startup India programme was launched in 2016. These ventures have generated more than two million jobs.

Among the honourees at this year's awards was Pranav